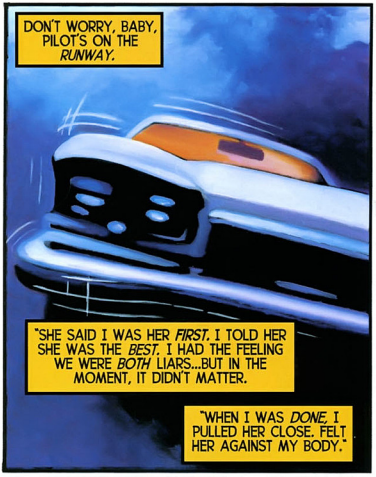

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"NO, WAIT. GO BACK. *THIS* WAS LINDA, REMEMBER?
"ONLY FIVE FOOT FOUR, BUT SHE WAS MY *MOUNTAIN OF LOVE.*"
OH, ASH...


KISS ME... *TOUCH* ME...
MMPHH! DAMN SEAT BELTS!


DON'T WORRY, BABY, PILOT'S ON THE *RUNWAY.*
"SHE SAID I WAS HER *FIRST.* I TOLD HER SHE WAS THE *BEST.* I HAD THE FEELING WE WERE *BOTH* LIARS...BUT IN THE MOMENT, IT DIDN'T MATTER.
"WHEN I WAS *DONE,* I PULLED HER CLOSE. FELT HER AGAINST MY BODY."


GAKK! AUGHH!
"WHAT A DIFFERENCE A *DAY* MAKES."
NOOOAAAGHH!
EYGHH! AAAHHRGGHH...
"I HAD DECAPITATED MY GIRLFRIEND. FLAILED AROUND THE YARD WITH HER *HEADLESS CORPSE.*"
GET... *OFF ME!*
"THAT WAS *IT.* WE WERE OFFICIALLY *OVER.*"

THE EVIL DEAD

Book 4 of 4

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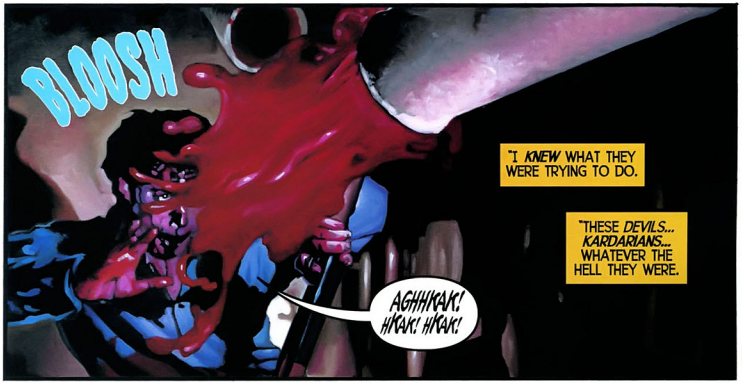

"THE CABIN WAS A BLOOD-DRENCHED *HELLHOLE.*
"BUT AFTER EVERYTHING I'D BEEN THROUGH *OUTSIDE,* IT FELT LIKE HOME SWEET...
"... *HOME.*"
WHO... WHO'S THERE?
WHATEVER'S BACK THERE...
...I SWEAR TO GOD, I'LL SHOOT!


EAGGHHHH!
NO!!
"IT WAS GODDAMN *CHERYL* AGAIN!
"GUESS SHE WANTED TO SAY HELLO TO MY LITTLE *FRIEND*...
"...AND I WAS *DONE* FEELING BAD ABOUT IT."
BLAM
GYAGHHH...

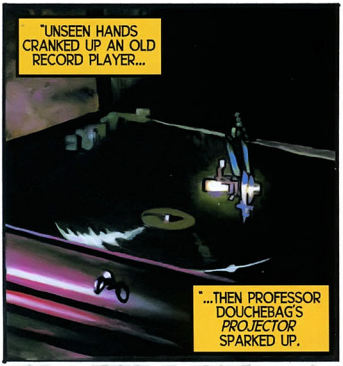

"NOT THAT CHERYL WAS REALLY *DEAD*. I COULD STILL HEAR HER *GROWLING* OUTSIDE."
NEED *SHELLS. AMMO!*
WHERE DID WE LEAVE THAT BOX OF--


"BASTARD *SCOTTY*. HE'D HOSED ME AGAIN. THE REST OF THE SHELLS WERE *DOWNSTAIRS*.
"I KEPT TELLIN' MYSELF, IT'S JUST DIRT AND ROCK...


"...AND PIPES."
WHAT THE *HELL*--?


BLOOSH
"I *KNEW* WHAT THEY WERE TRYING TO DO.
"THESE *DEVILS... KARDARIANS...* WHATEVER THE HELL THEY WERE.
AGHHKAK! HKAK! HKAK!


"THEY WERE TELLING ME THIS WASN'T *OVER.*


"UNSEEN HANDS CRANKED UP AN OLD RECORD PLAYER...
"...THEN PROFESSOR DOUCHEBAG'S *PROJECTOR* SPARKED UP.


"BETWEEN THE CRAP MUSIC AND THE SCREEN, IT WAS LIKE I WAS SUDDENLY A *PLAYER* IN SOME HELLISH *SILENT MOVIE.*
"BUT IF THIS HELLSPAWN THOUGHT I WAS GONNA PLAY *BUSTER KEATON* AND DANCE TO *THEIR TUNE...*

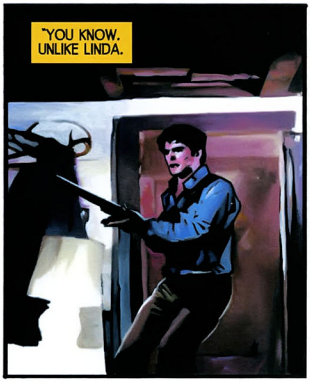

"...THEY COULD KISS MY *PUCKER.*"
NO...

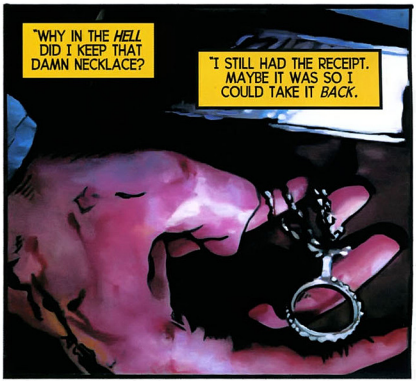

AH! SHELLS!
FEDERAL
WE'RE GONNA GET YOU. WE'RE GONNA GET YOU...
"FOR AN INSTANT, I THOUGHT I HEARD *LINDA'S* VOICE... *TAUNTING* ME FROM THE GRAVE."
"AND THEN IT ALL STOPPED.
"I DIDN'T KNOW IT THEN, BUT THERE HAD BEEN A CHANGE IN *STRATEGY.*


"PHASE ONE HAD BEEN A *FRONTAL ASSAULT.*
"PHASE TWO WAS SIMPLER.
"SCARE THE LIVIN' BEEJEESUS OUT OF ME."
AHHH!
BTAMM!
OH, GOD, NO. THE *HOUSE...*
...IT'S IN THE *HOUSE!!*

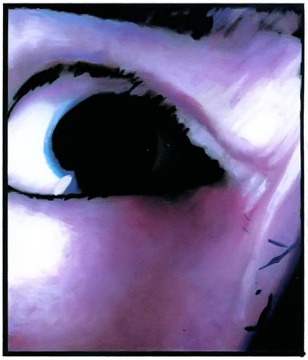

"THERE WERE NOISES EVERYWHERE. ON THE ROOF, IN THE *YARD*."
THERE YOU ARE.
"THEY WANTED ME TO DOUBT MY OWN *MIND*."
BASTARDS CAN'T TAKE MY *SANITY* FROM ME.
WAIT! NO... *NOOO!!*
EEEYAAGHH!!


"BUT I SAW THROUGH THEIR LITTLE GAME. THEY WERE TRYING TO *PSYCH ME OUT.*
"ALL I HAD TO DO WAS KEEP MY *HEAD.*


"YOU KNOW. UNLIKE LINDA.

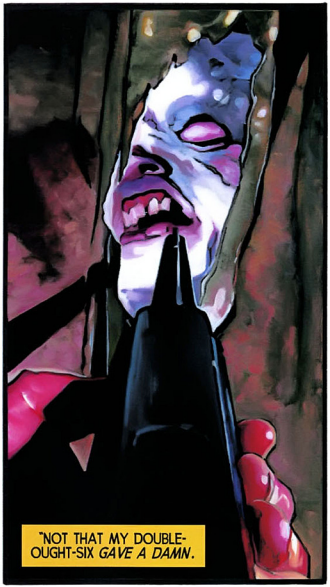

"WHY IN THE *HELL* DID I KEEP THAT DAMN NECKLACE?
"I STILL HAD THE RECEIPT. MAYBE IT WAS SO I COULD TAKE IT *BACK.*


"OR MAYBE...IT WAS BECAUSE I REALLY *LOVED* HER.
"AT LEAST THAT'S WHAT I TRIED TO *TELL* MYSELF..."
LINDA...




AGHHHH!!
EAGHHHH!!
JOIN US!
JOIN US!!!


"IT WAS CHERYL, AGAIN. I *THINK*..."
NO!!


"NOT THAT MY DOUBLE-OUGHT-SIX *GAVE A DAMN*.


"I KNOW IT SOUNDS *CALLOUS*, BUT ALL I COULD THINK WAS..."
KPOOM!
GYAGHKK!
"...HOW MANY TIMES WAS I GONNA HAVE TO *SHOOT* THAT BITCH?!"

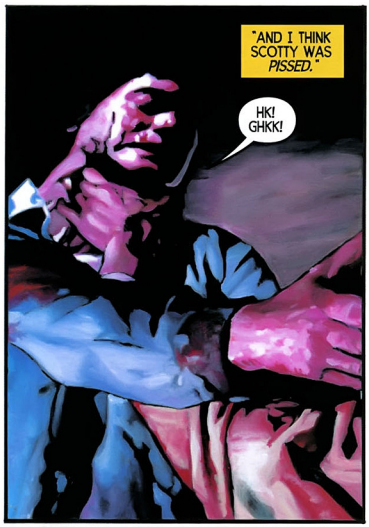

"WINDOW WAS *SHATTERED*, SO I'M NOT SURE WHAT I WAS THINKING WHEN I BLOCKED THE *FRONT DOOR*.


"ESPECIALLY SINCE MY OLD FRIEND *SCOTTY* WAS BUSY PLAYING *BATTERY BUNNY*."


ERAGHHH!
"SON OF A BITCH KEPT *GOING* AND *GOING* AND *GOING*...


WHMP
WHMP
"AND JUDGING FROM THE RACKET OUTSIDE, WHATEVER WAS LEFT OF CHERYL STILL WANTED A PIECE OF ME, TOO.
"TWO STEPS OVER AND *IT* COULD'VE JUST *WALKED INSIDE.*


"BUT EVEN THOUGH THEY WERE *STUPID*, THESE DEMONS WERE *STRONG*."
KRAKK!
AHGGG... GGHH... GGHH...
THAPP


"AND I THINK SCOTTY WAS *PISSED.*"
HK! GHKK!


"FUNNY. I HEARD THAT THE *EYES* WERE WINDOWS INTO THE *SOUL*.
"IF THAT WERE TRUE, THEN I WAS STARING STRAIGHT INTO THE BOWELS OF *HELL*.
"AND *SCOTTY*...
"...I DIDN'T GIVE A DAMN *WHAT* HE WAS SEEING ANYMORE."
AGGHHHHH!!
"I WAS GOING THROUGH *FRIENDS* FASTER THAN A MASERATI IN A *SCHOOL ZONE*...
"...AND THERE DIDN'T SEEM TO BE ANY *END* IN SIGHT.
"THAT'S WHEN I NOTICED THAT WHATEVER WAS LEFT OF *SCOTTY* WAS SENDING UP *SMOKE SIGNALS*.
"TWO PLUS TWO SUDDENLY EQUALLED *FOUR*. BURN THE BOOK, BURN THE *DEMONS*.

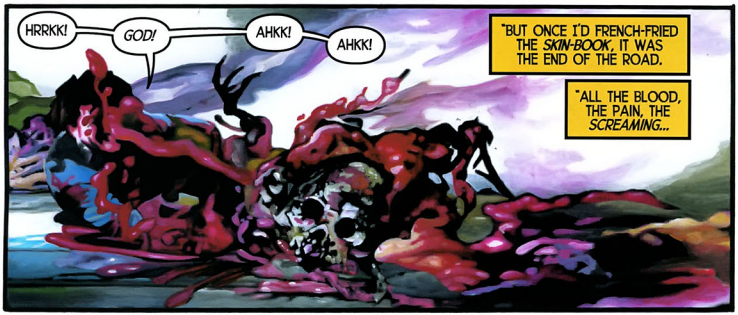

"TRICK WAS GONNA BE MAKING IT *HAPPEN*."
JOINNN USSSSS...
JOIN US!
MMPHH!
"I COULD SEE IT, JUST *INCHES* FROM THE FLAMES."


GOTTA...GET... THE DAMNED *BOOK!*
"THEN I REMEMBERED THE *NECKLACE*... *LINDA'S* NECKLACE...
"IF I COULD JUST...*REACH IT!*"
WHAKRAK
AAGHH!
"OF COURSE, SINCE I'M HERE TO *TELL IT*, YOU PROBABLY ALREADY KNOW HOW IT FINALLY TURNED OUT."
GOT IT!


SUCK ON THIS!
"THAT'S RIGHT. BURN, BABY, BURN!"
EEYAAA... UHHHHHH...
HGK...KUK... KUK...
"RIGHT TO THE BITTER END, THOSE KANDARIAN GOONS TRIED TO GET THEIR MITTS ON ME...


BOLTON


"...THOSE *PERSISTENT* SONS OF BITCHES."
JOIN USSS... JOIN USSSSSS...


HRRKK!
GOD!
AHKK!
AHKK!
"BUT ONCE I'D FRENCH-FRIED THE *SKIN-BOOK*, IT WAS THE END OF THE ROAD.
"ALL THE BLOOD, THE PAIN, THE *SCREAMING*...


"...IT WAS *OVER*.


"DON'T ASK ME HOW, BUT SUDDENLY THE SUN WAS OUT. BIRDS WERE CHIRPING.
"EVERYTHING WAS... NORMAL...
"EVERYTHING...
"...WAS GONNA BE...
"...ALL RIGHT..."
EEEYAAAARGHH!!!


"THEN I WOKE UP.
"ALL OF A SUDDEN, I WAS IN MY CAR-- LEAST I *THINK* IT WAS MY CAR.
"I MUST HAVE FALLEN *ASLEEP.* WINDOWS WERE ALL FOGGED UP. JESUS, HOW LONG HAD I *BEEN* THERE?"
RGHH!!!
GUH! HUH? WHA--?!


ASH!

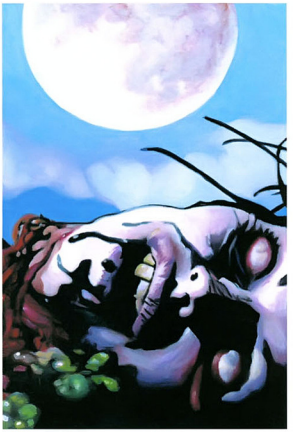

COME ON, SLEEPYHEAD, WE'RE HERE!


"WAS IT REALLY THAT *SIMPLE?* WAS IT ALL JUST A *DREAM?* SCOTTY, CHERYL, SHELLY--I'D JUST *MADE THEM UP?*
"IT HAD BEEN ONE BITCHIN' *NIGHTMARE,* BUT THAT'S *ALL* IT WAS.
"I HAD A FEELING THE BEST WAS YET TO COME!"

DEADITE LETTER OFFICE

Write to us at:
10956 SE Main St., Milwaukie, OR 97222
philips@darkhorse.com

Once again, we've received an avalanche of letters in response to Mark and John's breathtaking series—Ash's original "two-handed" cabin ordeal! We probably could have filled twenty-two of these pages with your emails alone! Thanks for being so vocal and letting us know how many Evil Dead *fans have been enjoying a comic series that's true to the spirit (undead or otherwise) of the original film. Before I let your letters run wild, I'd like to direct your attention to Mr. John Bolton's website, where you'll find his hilarious "biography" section, gorgeous vampires, comic book pages for sale, and much more! Go to johnbolton.com—and visit darkhorse.com to read more about Dark Horse's horror line and to continue our* Evil Dead *love-fest on the Dark Horse message boards. Enough from me, let's hear what you have to say . . .*



Dear *Dead* Guys,

I still remember being blown away by John Bolton's amazing painted interiors on Dark Horse's original *Army of Darkness* adaptation. I mean, what movie adaptation even warrants that kind of artistry? Well, to *my* mind *Army of Darkness* did, but I was shocked to learn that anyone else thought so! And even *more* shocked to learn that Bolton was making a second trip into those woods to paint an adaptation of the movie that started it all. *The Evil Dead* #1 was everything I hoped it would be. It recaptured the experience of reading that original *AOD* comic fifteen years ago and gave me a chance to relive one of my favorite horror movies ever through new eyes. It was really one of the most totally satisfying comics I've read in a while. John's panels were reliably exquisite, and Mark kept the pacing perfect! Coupled with the recent *Evil Dead* musical, you guys proved that this simple setup of five teenagers and a bunch of Kandarian demons in a cabin in the woods really *is* a classic tale open to–and worthy of–multiple interpretations and retellings. Thank you! I really hope that Mark and John can get together again eventually and give us a similar take on the crown jewel in the franchise, *Evil Dead 2*. It would be a dream come true to see Bolton paint the entire trilogy!

Matthew Bradford, via email

Hey, guys! I love the retelling so far. Great artwork. I saw *The Evil Dead* back in 1988, in high school. We used to rent horror movies by the casket-load. We had one rule . . . no movies with drawings for the cover (that usually meant they were pretty bad). So we skipped *The Evil Dead* many times. Then we were at a friend's house and they were gonna watch a horror movie. I didn't pay attention at first, then BAM, like a pencil to the ankle it had my attention. I was seriously scared crapless. Everyone was. The whole group was totally quiet. The gore, the camera angles, the vines . . . everything was just awesome. Once I caught my breath, I finally asked what the hell we just watched . . . they said *The Evil Dead*. Holy Deadites, we skipped this movie many times . . . I had no idea the effect it would have on me. I had been watching horror for years, and nothing took hold of me like *The Evil Dead* did. Since then, I have watched the move a gabillion times, met Sam, Bruce, Tom Sullivan, and the Ladies a bunch of times. I have made an *Evil Dead* coloring book and an *Evil Dead* board game, and I've been to the cabin (what is left of it) three times. After all these years I still cannot put my severed finger on what it is about *The Evil Dead* that does it for me, but whatever it is, man . . . I friggin' love it. One by one we will take you . . .

Jason Ryf, via email

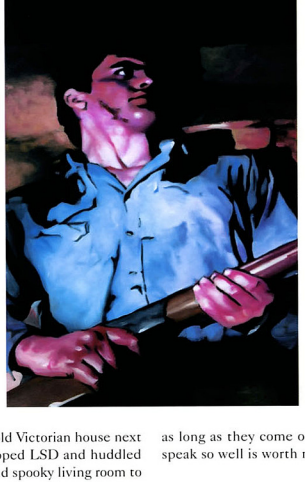
Gentlemen, I have to hand it to you guys . . . just when you thought that all things *Evil Dead* were done—and you'll pardon the pun—to death, along comes your brand-spanking-new adaptation of the original classic. While most adaptations of this sort fail miserably, the new *Evil Dead* comic hits the mark and fires on all cylinders. Mark Verheiden has cleverly expanded and even enhanced the original script. No easy feat, to be sure. And as for John Bolton's mind-bending artwork . . . well, long time Dead-Heads have been aware of his unique blend of genius since he

did his classic adaptation of *Army of Darkness*. Keep knockin' us dead!

Chris Sasser, via email

Kudos on the new *Evil Dead* series. As a huge fan of the film trilogy, I was quite pleased. Brilliant artwork and quirky dialogue while still remaining faithful to the source material. The first time I saw *The Evil Dead* was at my eleventh birthday party. My two best friends and I had already experienced *Army of Darkness* and were huge fans by the time we discovered there were two other films in the series a few months later. So my birthday party seemed like the perfect opportunity to break in Ash's earlier adventures (or misadventures, rather). I don't think my mom knew what she was getting us into.

Brett Warwick, via email



I was truly and seriously blown away by the first issue of *The Evil Dead*! Amazing job, Dark Horse!! I almost passed on it, thinking it was another silly Ash comic, and then I opened it. John's art is friggin' fantastic!! Then I read it, and I just want to congratulate Mark on a fantastic story. The additions were perfectly placed and added more spark into the story without being trite. For a film I love so much and have watched countless times, you managed to keep me constantly interested and excited until the end. Anyway, the first time I watched *Evil Dead* . . . I guess it was some time in the mid-to-late 80s. I know I was in upstate New York with a group of old headbanger friends in a large old Victorian house next to a funeral home. We all dropped LSD and huddled together in the big shadowy and spooky living room to watch the film late at night. The spookiest thing was that the guy's family owned the funeral home next door to their house. I remember people started passing out cause it was very late and the acid wasn't so strong. But I can remember being fully awake and really enthralled with the film. Then I started looking out the shade-less windows and getting creeped out by the funeral home next door. I tried to wake everyone up, but they wouldn't budge. My friend's dog kept making funny sounds and slight barks while looking out the windows. I called her over and resorted to hugging the giant black lab like a scared baby in a fetal position. I kept telling myself, "You made it through *The Exorcist*, you can do this." Watching *The Evil Dead* on this occasion was truly like riding a roller coaster for the first time. I made them all watch it again the next day, and it was just as exciting. *The Evil Dead* is one of the special few films which evokes different reactions during each viewing. Can't wait for the next issue(s). I have been reading comics since the 80s and this really is the first letter I've ever sent off to the editors. Thank You Very Much!

"Chaley666," via email

Just wanted to say Bolton's work is friggin' awesome! I love great cover art that catches my eye, and when I cracked #1 open and saw that ALL the panels were the same quality, I almost ripped the pages out to frame them. I'm a longtime fan of the *Evil Dead* series and now a John Bolton follower, too! Keep up the good work!

David, Kentucky
(a few hours away from "the cabin," ya know!)

I just wanted to congratulate this foray into the cult hit *The Evil Dead*. When my comics guy put it in my hands, my first reaction was, "Ash has two hands!"—quickly followed by, "Eh, might as well . . ." Though my first thoughts were not of the best sort, I soon found that I enjoyed it immensely, and I can't wait for the second issue. I'm the sort of person who reads fan-fiction based on films, just to see how other people portray things I already know. So the fact that this isn't a word-for-word adaptation is of great enjoyment to me. I will definitely keep buying these comics for as long as they come out. Any writer who does Ash-speak so well is worth my money.

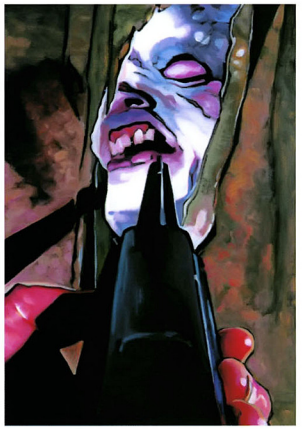
Andy Duncan, via email

First of all, beautiful work on this comic! I'm loving every panel of it. I really enjoy the extra bits that Mr. Verheiden is giving his readers as well. *The Evil Dead* (and its twisted cousin, *Evil Dead 2*) rank in my all-time favorite top-ten movies, and as a movie "purist" (whatever the hell that means), I usually dislike added bits in adaptations. But for some reason, it works with this film. Maybe because I always wanted to see more Ash/Deadite/bloodbath action in the vein of the original movies. Anyway, I saw *Evil Dead 2* first. I fell in love. The twelve different colors of blood, the severed and possessed hand, the infamous eyeball scene, and the freaky-as-hell deadites. I was hooked. I was around seventeen and every party we ever had in my parents'

house would host *Evil Dead 2*. It was a tradition. Or rather . . . a sickness. I couldn't stop. And my friends came to expect it. Then I saw *The Evil Dead*. Wow! FUCK!!! Was that ever scary! The lighting, the camera angles twisting you into the changing faces of the hapless Deadite victims . . . getting sucked into their lifeless eyes and seeing these twisted versions of humans smack dab in my living room. High school was never the same. I wanted more zombie/Deadite goodness. But sadly I was denied Deadites until now, with your amazing retelling of the classic. Thank you guys. Thank you so much!

Ethan Slayton, via email

I first heard about this project late last year and was very excited to see that John Bolton was doing the art. I thought, "Wow, this is gonna be cool." I knew the art would be good. I wasn't sure how the writing would be, but that was done well. I liked how the new parts flowed with the original plot. I also liked the fact that the new scenes didn't take over the story. I thought the book had a good pace and was accurate to the movie. All in all, I would say you've done a good job putting this horror classic into comic book form. It's nice to see one of my all-time favorite flicks this way. It's very rare that I buy any new comics. I was very disappointed in comics during the 90s and have since devoted my collecting to books from the 1960s up to the late 1980s. I love old comics and have little faith in new ones. *The Evil Dead* book has shown me that there are still some good writers and artists out there. I'm looking forward to #2.



Ed Holmes, Demotte, Indiana

Dear Dark Horse, let me start by saying THANK YOU for finally bringing one of my all-time favorite movies to comic book form! *The Evil Dead* and its sequels hold a special place in my life . . . they're what started my lifelong love of horror movies! Here is how it started . . . when I was in elementary school, my parents would only let me rent G or PG movies from the local video store. Remember, this was in the day of VHS tapes and clear plastic slipcovers for the cases. My local video store put stickers on the front of the slipcase that showed the movies' ratings. Well, as I was browsing the movies just looking for PG stickers, something caught my eye . . . the cool cover for a movie entitled *The Evil Dead*. This movie looked way too cool to be rated PG. Turns out, someone at the store put the wrong slipcase on the movie. So my mom let me rent it since the sticker said PG . . . and the rest is history. Thanks to some kid who worked at that video store and wasn't paying attention, I got to discover *The Evil Dead* in all its gory wonder!!

Hayes Hudson, Fayetteville, Arizona

Hey, Philip! So I'm out in Long Island this weekend doing some shopping at the mall. I drive by this cool comic store called Amok Time, and my girlfriend and I pop in to take a peek—and there's an all-new *Evil Dead* comic on the shelf. Not an *Army of Darkness* comic (Ick!), but an actual *Evil Dead* comic. Imagine my surprise when I see you listed as editor, too! Keen! At any rate, the comic was great. It was nice to see Bolton illustrating Ash again, and the script was really faithful to the original film, which was refreshingly nice to see. I'm really looking forward to seeing how the other three issues pan out.

Ian Jane,
New York, New York

Why the hell'd you move out to New York, Ian? We miss you! Watch your tense shifts *when you write your film reviews online (Google him!) and in your fan letters to Dark Horse. And you'll note that I coedited this series with Michael Carrigliito, another dear friend who moved away. Okay, everyone, thanks for reading and for sharing your fun letters. Special thanks to the four readers who actually took the time to send in old-fashioned handwritten letters. That was quaint. You can continue talk about our* Evil Dead *series over at the Dark Horse message boards at darkhorse.com. My next foray into Dark Horse Horror will be with the* Pigeons From Hell *series, with our first* Pigeons *issue out this month. Joe Lansdale, Nathan Fox, and Dave Stewart deliver a unique Robert E. Howard adaptation that begins in a broken-down mansion filled with dead things. It's also set in Acadiana, the region of Louisiana I grew up in. (Lots of scary things there, right Ryan R.?) Anyway, until we can convince Sam, Rob, Mark, and John to take us back to that Evil Cabin . . . keep screaming.*



—Philip Simon




RACER X
crossing the finish line with another scan!
STILL THE MARK OF EXCELLENCE!
DCP